

CHAPTER THREE

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

In this chapter, research methodology contains research design, which explains the design chosen by the researcher, as appropriate for the study, the chapter has study population, sample size, sampling technique, method of data collection, unit of analysis, content category, and method of data presentation and analysis.

3.1 Research Design

This study adopted the content analysis research design. Content analysis allows for the assay of what is contained within content, or data, forming sequitur and educing about it (Nachmias & Nachmias, 1976), having a non-officious form of analysis of communication, the result of the communication being peruse and disregarding the results of individual's answers to questions (Prasad, 2008).

Oyero (2011: 9), simplifies the definition of content analysis, as “a method of studying and analysing communication in a systematic, objective and quantitative manner to measure variables”, (Wimmer and Dominick, 2003:141).

From the above findings of what content analysis is, the researcher found it appropriate to make use of this method.

3.2 Study Population

The population for this study comprised all newspapers' issues of *The Guardian* and *The Punch* newspapers published in Nigeria between 2019 and 2020.

The total population was 1462 issues of both dailies, 731 for each newspaper. *The Guardian* was purposively selected because of its coverage, national circulation, respect and reach within the borders of Nigeria.

The Guardian as described by The New York Times is "Nigeria's most respected newspaper", because of its style of reportage and fairness in reports. This paper is one of the few existing newspapers that were established before Nigeria's independence.

The Punch according to Nigeria Finder, 2019 is listed among the top ten newspapers; this paper was selected because is regarded by several reports (Nigeria News Network, 1999, Quora, 2020) as the widely most widely read and most popular newspaper in the nation.

Therefore, the base of the information above, the research selected these newspapers because of their reputation, content and coverage.

3.3 Sample Size

A total of 400 issues of the selected newspapers constituted the sample size out of 1462 population of both newspapers. This sample procedure used was Taro Yamane, which states

n =	$\frac{N}{1+N(0.05)^2}$
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n =	$\frac{1462}{1+1462 (0.05)^2}$
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n =	$\frac{1462}{1463 (0.0025)}$
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n =	$\frac{1462}{3.6575}$
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n =	$399.7 (400)$
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Therefore, the sample size for this study is 400 issues.

Through the use of simple random sampling, the researcher selects this sample size on the publications published on the working days of the week, including holidays. Thus, 200 issues per newspaper yielded 400 for the two selected newspapers.

Eight issues were selected per months for each newspaper, 16 for both publications, a total of 192 for each newspaper, 384 for both, this means there is a remaining of 8 issues and 16 in total. Therefore, the research randomly selects from the unselected issues.

The unit of analysis comprised all articles or stories on human trafficking in the form of the news story, editorial, editorial cartoon, and pictogram. They were examined for frequency of human trafficking reported; the prominence is given to the reports in terms of newspaper page placements and examined the effect human trafficking has on nation's development. The data were analyzed using percentages.

3.4 Sampling Technique

The researcher made use of simple random sampling to select the newspaper issues. Simple random sampling is one of the probability sampling technique in which all members of the population are given an "equal chance of being selected", (Senam 2020:33). Simple random sampling can be used in either of the following ways, the former, is non – replacement of subject after selection, Senam (2020:33) simple stated it as when "a member of the population that is selected (in the study size) is removed from the fold (remains of the population) and cannot be selected again.

While, the latter, is the replacement of subject after selection, this means any "member selected of the population that is selected has a further chance of been selected", (Senam, 2020:33), then return to the congregation of study size.

Therefore, the researcher used the former form of simple random sampling technique, owing to the fact that all unit of study deserves the chance to be selected, when selected; this subject will be removed from the congregation of study size.

3.5 Instrument for Data Collection

The instrument of data collection used in this study is coding sheet. The coding sheet is a standardized sheet that helps to ease coding and allows the coder to classify data by placing checkmarks in the predetermined space (Wimmer & Dominick, 2003). The researcher in line with the research objectives and questions generated the coding sheet.

3.6 Intercoder Reliability

A reliable measure is dependable, stable and consistent from one season to another. A study is reliable when repeated measurement of the same materials results in similar decisions or conclusions. (Ekeanyanwu, 2010).

In order to achieve reliability of the research instrument (which is coding sheet) and the content category, a draft was given to the project supervisor for cross checking. These concepts of intercoder reliability shows that the instrument of this material is concise with the appropriate measurement for this study.

3.7 Unit of Analysis

The units of analysis for the study are news story, editorial, editorial cartoon, and pictogram.

Units of analysis are the “genres of mass media content under which the stories to be analysed are placed” (Senam, 2020:64), in short, the assembly that wears all the content categories of the research. Moreover, the unit of analysis of this research was determined by the researcher.

3.8 Content Category

The following are content categories examined in this study:

- The selected newspapers were examined and coded on reported issues in their publications. The newspapers selected are *The Guardian* and *The Punch* newspapers.
- Frequency of coverage: The frequency of coverage will be determined through physical counting of the subject as published under the unit of analysis.
- Prominence: the researcher categorised the front-page items as most prominent, the back page as prominent and inside pages items as least prominent.
- Journalistic genres used in this study are straight news, editorial, editorial cartoon, and pictogram.
- Direction of reportage, this category is subject into three; positive (discouraging human trafficking), negative (glorifying human trafficking) and neutral (neither encouraging nor discouraging, just a story).
- Which form of human trafficking as identified by INTERPOL, was most frequently reported by the selected newspapers.

CHAPTER FOUR

PRESENTATION AND ANALYSIS OF DATA

4.1 Data Presentation

The result of the analysis of the data is presented based on the research questions in chapter one as well as the content categories used for the content analysis. The data gathered were presented in tables and accomplished with their analysis. The discussions of findings are done based on the findings drawn from the analysis of the content.

The qualitative analysis method was used for analysing the data gathered. The sample size for this study as mentioned in chapter one was 400 newspapers gotten from *The Punch* and *The Guardian Newspapers*. Out of the 400 newspapers, only 282 contents relating to human trafficking were discovered and gathered.

Table 4.1 Coded Sheets

Research Question 1:

1. How frequent are human trafficking stories in selected newspapers?

Table 4.1

Table 4.1

Paper	Frequency	Percent
The Guardian	105	37.2
The Punch	177	62.8
Total	282	100%

In Table 4.1, there was a slight gap in stories reported by selected newspaper, *The Punch* has 62.8 percent which translate into 177 stories discovered in 200 newspaper, while *The Guardian* had 37.2 percent, 105 stories from 200 newspapers.

As reflected in the Table 4.1, *The Punch* newspaper reported more human trafficking stories than *The Guardian*.

Research Question 2:

What is the prominence given to human trafficking stories in selected newspapers?

Table 4.2:

Prominence * Paper Cross-tabulation			
Prominence	Paper		Total
	The Guardian	The Punch	
Front Page	3.90%	8.20%	12.10%
Back Page	0.70%	0.70%	1.40%
Inside Page	32.60%	53.90%	86.50%
Total	37.20%	62.80%	100.00%

Table 4.2 presents the prominence given to human trafficking stories in *The Guardian* and *The Punch* newspapers, it was discovered that 86.5 percent of stories gathered were placed in inside page, which sum up to 244 stories, front page has 34 stories,12.1 percentage and back page 1.4 percentage, 4 stories.

As observed, there was indeed a huge gap in placement of stories on human trafficking as most stories were placed in the inside pages, giving less priority and prominence to human trafficking, also, stories in the inside pages attracts less attention.

Research Question 3:

Which journalistic genres was used to report the human trafficking stories?

Table 4.3

Journalistic Genres * Paper Crosstabulation			
Journalistic Genres	Paper		Total
	The Guardian	The Punch	
Straight News	26.20%	41.80%	68.10%
Editorial	0.00%	2.10%	2.10%
Editorial Cartoon	3.20%	0.00%	3.20%
Picture News	2.50%	13.80%	16.30%
Feature	5.30%	5.00%	10.30%
Total	37.20%	62.80%	100.00%

Table 4.3 indicates the most used journalistic genres in reporting human trafficking stories. The table establishes the fact that straight news has been the most used journalistic genres in reporting stories on human trafficking, with 68.1 percent of all stories been straight news, pictures news had 16.3%, 10.3% of the stories were feature stories, editorial and editorial cartoon had 2.1% and 3.2% respectively.

Research Question 4:

Which types of human trafficking is reported by selected newspapers?

Table 4.4

Forms of Human Trafficking * Paper * Journalistic Genres Crosstabulation				
Journalistic Genres	Forms of Human Trafficking	Paper		Total
Straight News	Trafficking for forced labour	The Guardian	3.1%	12.5%
	Trafficking for forced criminal activities		26%	53.1%
	Trafficking in women for sexual exploitation		4.7%	21.4%
	Trafficking for the removal of organs		0%	1.6%
	People smuggling		4.7%	11.5%
	Total		38.5%	100%
Editorial	Trafficking for forced labour		0%	33.3%
	Trafficking for forced criminal activities		0%	16.7%
	Trafficking in women for sexual exploitation		0%	33.3%
	Trafficking for the removal of organs		0%	0.0%
	People smuggling		0%	16.7%
	Total		0%	100%
Editorial Cartoon	Trafficking for forced labour		0%	0%
	Trafficking for forced criminal activities		100%	100%
	Trafficking in women for sexual exploitation		0%	0%
	Trafficking for the removal of organs		0%	0%
	People smuggling		0%	0%
	Total		100%	100%
Picture News	Trafficking for forced labour		0%	10.9%
	Trafficking for forced criminal activities		8.7%	39.1%
	Trafficking in women for sexual exploitation		6.5%	39.1%
	Trafficking for the removal of organs		0%	2.2%
	People smuggling		0%	8.7%
	Total		15.2%	100%
Feature	Trafficking for forced labour		6.9%	13.8%
	Trafficking for forced criminal activities		31%	44.8%
	Trafficking in women for sexual exploitation		10.3%	34.5%

	Trafficking for the removal of organs	0%	0%	0%
	People smuggling	3.4%	3.4%	6.9%
	Total	51.7%	48.3%	100%
Total	Trafficking for forced labour	2.8%	9.6%	12.4%
	Trafficking for forced criminal activities	25.5%	25.2%	50.7%
	Trafficking in women for sexual exploitation	5.3%	19.9%	25.2%
	Trafficking for the removal of organs	0%	1.4%	1.4%
	People smuggling	3.5%	6.7%	10.3%
	Total	37.2%	62.8%	100%

Table 4.4 presents the types of human trafficking reported by selected newspapers. The result of the table establishes that trafficking for criminal activities has the highest number of stories, which stood at 50.7%, succeeding is 25.2% of trafficking in women for sexual exploitation, trafficking for forced labour had 12.4%, trafficking for the removal of organs and people smuggling had 1.4% and 10.3% respectively.

Table 4.5

Direction	Percentage
Positive	63.8
Negative	28.7
Neutral	7.4
Total	100.0
	n = 400

Table 4.5 presents the direction given to human trafficking stories in The Guardian and The Punch newspapers, it was discovered 63.8 percent of stories gathered were positive stories, negative stories were 28.7% and neutral stories were 7.4% of the data collected.

Table 4.6

Paper * Direction Cross Tabulation					
		Direction			Total
		Positive	Negative	Neutral	
The Guardian	Percentage (%)	17.7%	16.3%	3.2%	37.2%
The Punch	Percentage (%)	46.1%	12.4%	4.3%	62.8%
Total	Percentage(%) of Total	63.8%	28.7%	7.4%	100.0%

Table 4.6 indicates the direction given to human trafficking stories in *The Guardian* and *The Punch* newspapers in cross tabulation, the table shows that 17.7% of positive stories were reported in *The Guardian* and *The Punch* 46.1%, *The Punch* reported 12.4% of negative stories and 4.3% of neutral stories, while *The Guardian* reported 16.3% and 3.2% of negative and neutral stories respectively.

The study categorised the front-page items as most prominent, the back page as prominent and inside pages items as least prominent. Therefore, media houses gave stories of human trafficking least prominent.

Table 4.7

Paper * Journalistic Genres Cross Tabulation							
		Journalistic Genres					Total
		Straight News	Editorial	Editorial Cartoon	Picture News	Feature	
The Guardian	Percentage (%)	26.2%	0.0%	3.2%	2.5%	5.3%	37.2%
The Punch							

Total	Percentage (%)	41.8%	2.1%	0.0%	13.8%	5.0%	62.8%
	Percentage (%) of Total	68.1%	2.1%	3.2%	16.3%	10.3%	100.0%

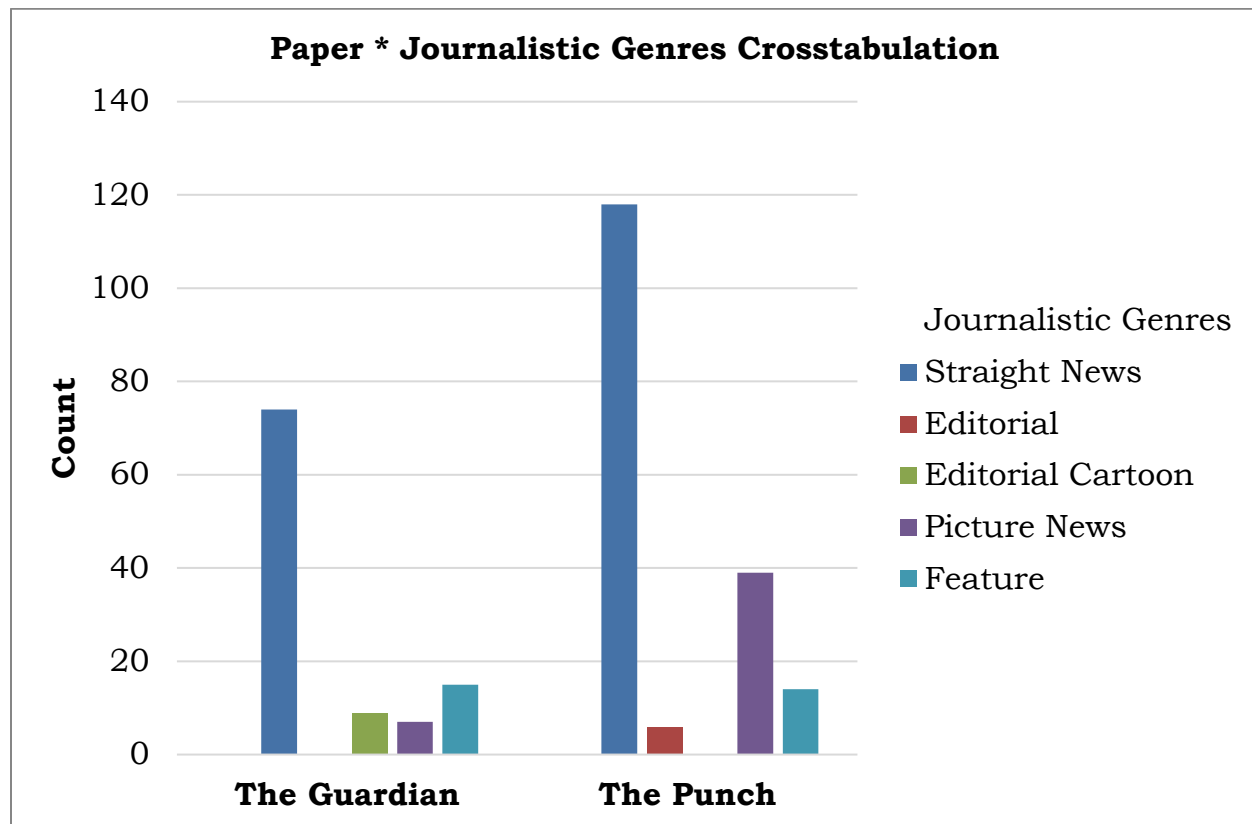


Table 4.6 indicates the journalistic genres of human trafficking stories in *The Guardian* and *The Punch* newspapers in cross tabulation, the table shows that the newspapers presented human trafficking issues as straight news, 68.1%, features 10.3%, editorial had 2.1%, while editorial cartoon and pictures 3.2% and 16.3% respectively.

The chart shows the level of which journalistic genres were used by *The Guardian* and *The Punch* newspapers in presented stories of human trafficking. The chart indicates that *The Punch*

newspaper mostly used straight news but had no story featured in editorial cartoon. While *The Guardian* newspaper also presented most of its stories in straight news but had no editorial.

4.2 Discussion of Findings

The extent of coverage given to human trafficking by *The Guardian* and *The Punch* newspapers shows an average reportage of human trafficking issues. A total of 200 issues of each newspaper were sampled for analysis, making a total of 400 issues. It is amazing that only 105 stories (37.2%) came from *The Guardian*, *The Punch* had 177 stories (62.8%). This means that there were several days when human trafficking issues did not feature at all in the newspapers. If the newspapers were to feature a human trafficking story every day, we would have 400 stories. Thus, a study of 282 stories shows that more attention has to be given to human trafficking issues in the dailies.

There are some imaginable elucidations for this. Journalists may consider young people to be unimportant in public executive processes, or immature, ill-informed or indeed, not interested in existing challenges. Furthermore, young people do not buy newspapers on a daily basis, nor do they typically have the disposable cash to do so. Not only that, the code of ethics for journalists in Nigeria suggests that journalists should not interview or photograph those under the age of 18 and victims above 18 on subjects involving their personal welfare in their absence and without their consent (Nigerian Guild of Editors, n.d.), this might give rise to editorial delays, it could discourage journalists from using credible sources and pictures for stories. As a rule, journalists prefer to eat at tables where information is readily available and easily accessible.

Siebert, Peterson and Schramm (1956) stated that social responsibility theory posits the need for the press to carry out its duties with all level of obligation and responsibility and should be majorly guided by self-regulation and government regulation (if and when necessary).

(Nwabueze C. 2012: 94), therefore in achieving positive and responsible media; it is only wise for the government to embark on acts and policies that will support the media.

The finding has also shown that *The Punch* newspaper gave greater attention to human trafficking than *The Guardian* did; the difference in the coverage is very significant. As observed in the data presentation, *The Punch* newspaper had better reportage in respect of human trafficking stories than *The Guardian*.

The newspapers espoused a variety of journalism genres in the reportage of human trafficking. The newspapers predominantly used the 'straight news' format in reporting human trafficking. In interpretation, newspapers are more concerned with delivering first-hand news of human trafficking to the public. Straight news comes in piecemeal and does not allow for a comprehensive report. Features and editorials are more appropriate for thorough treatment of any issue. They allow background information to be gathered and provide detailed information to educate the readers on any issue. The newspapers, however, did not use the feature genre much and editorial in their reportage: an evidence of lack of depth in their treatment of child rights' issues.

There is low enlightening and in-depth analysis on the subjects of human trafficking, as reflected in the low coverage of feature stories. This shows that the newspapers either did not carry the readers (publics) along actively on the issue of human trafficking, or the newspapers are not just interested in human trafficking stories. We also see that the newspapers did not get involved in presenting many features or in-depth reports on the human trafficking issues. 2.1% of all the stories were in the form of editorials, 10.3% were in form of features, while 4% of the stories were in the form of editorials. In fact, the newspapers reported the issues mostly as straight news with over 68.1%. There is therefore no balance in the reportage of human trafficking.

The Guardian newspaper had no stories in form of editorials as the samples analysed, *The Punch* with 6 counts (2.1%). In fact, both newspapers reported the issues mostly as straight news with over 68.1%.

The researcher noticed that *The Punch* newspaper had scare editorials and no editorial cartoons while *The Guardian* had no editorials and few editorial cartoons. It is fun to note that both newspapers either write editorial or editorial cartoons.

The prominence of a story in terms of page placement has implications for the amount to which newspapers may bring any subject to the forefront of public debate. The findings reveal that reports on human trafficking were hidden inside the pages of newspapers. This reflects the low newsworthiness of human trafficking stories. The Monitor (n.d.) exemplified the significance of front-page news as representing great and eminence of newsworthiness. It was noticed that every front page amplifies the articles that appear on it (Oyero,2011).

The front-page article in The New York Times, for example, will almost certainly be carried on the evening news, summarized by wire services, ripped-off by ten thousand blogs, and generally distributed everywhere. Front-page articles in the New York Times have tremendous impact on elections, national policy, and even the start of wars.

Moreover, most radio and television stations engage its listeners in newspapers review, for example, Television Continental's The Morning Show has a newspaper review slotted in the programme by 8.00 am, Channels Television's Sunrise has a newspaper review by 7.00 am, 7.30 am on Nigeria Info FM' Morning Crossfire and Faaji FM's Newspaper Review by 6.15 am. The concentration of human trafficking on the inner pages implies that the newspapers did not regard human trafficking concerns as a topic worthy of special attention.

The analysis of the reports also focused on different types of human trafficking as identified by INTERPOL. Most of the substantive pieces concerned with human trafficking against women for sexual exploitation. These different inhuman kinds of human trafficking include trafficking for forced labour, trafficking for forced criminal activities, trafficking in women for sexual exploitation, trafficking for the removal of organs and people smuggling. Of truth, newspapers reported on efforts being made to redress harmful or generally disadvantageous situations that victims of human traffickers faced. These included governments' activities to that effect; the efforts of advocates, NGOs and efforts discuss and implement new strategies to raise awareness and to advocate for prevention and provision of remedies for victims of human trafficking. It is worth mentioning that welfare of those who have fallen prey of human traffickers was generously reported on by the newspapers.

CHAPTER FIVE

SUMMARY, CONCLUSION AND RECOMMENDATION

5.1 Summary

This study investigates the level of coverage of human trafficking in The Punch and The Guardian newspapers. Human trafficking menaces frequently grow in our society as reported in chapter two of this study. Therefore, in order to ascertain the damages as claimed by international organisations and monitoring bodies against inhuman activities, this necessitate this research. The two major objectives of this study is to ascertain the frequency of reportage given to human trafficking and the prominence of coverage of human trafficking in the selected newspapers. The literature review covered the concept, theories, and review of past studies, the theoretical framework for this study is the social responsibility theory. The study adopted the quantitative content analysis using coding sheet as an instrument of data collection. The population for this study comprises of all issues of 2019 and 2020, summing up to 1462 publications of The Punch and The Guardian newspapers, and 400 were selected using the Yaro Tamaro formula. The researcher discovered that human trafficking stories were reported but significant importance was not given to stories of human trafficking. The research recommended that this study should be further studied, modified and worked upon in the future by proficient researcher and scholars.

5.2 Conclusion

In light of the aforementioned, newspaper reporters and editors should pay more attention to human trafficking news. With respect to human rights in our society and the media's important role in ensuring these rights are realized and enforced, it is necessary for newspapers to give these stories more prominence. As a first step, they should consider dedicating special pages to human trafficking issues, where issues impacting their rights and violations of these rights must be addressed. Constant awareness of the techniques human traffickers put on potential victims. Information on human trafficking must be made widely known to the public, thus issues linked to human trafficking should be handled on specialized pages that can attract and impact public interest in such pages when information on human trafficking is needed.

Straight news dominates the research, according to the data; this alone allows the audience to get first-hand information. However, the news media must report on human trafficking in a variety of print media genres. As a result, readers will be able to get a complete picture of such stories by presenting them in feature format. Additionally, opinion columns and letters to the editor will allow for the expression of opposing viewpoints, which will aid policymakers in understanding the public's perspective on the topic at hand.

In addition, in order to establish an agenda for human trafficking stories, it is necessary to show the concerns to the placement of stories in newspapers. Therefore, newspapers should strive to present more articles on their front and back pages. When someone reads a newspaper, the front page and the back page are the first things they look at before diving into the content inside. As a result, putting stories on the first (main) page will make them more newsworthy. Many stories vie for space on the first page, but one approach to avoid this is to place select human trafficking news headlines on the front page, and continue the stories inside. Thus, the subject of human trafficking will be raised.

Finally, the researcher gives great accolades to those reporting human trafficking stories, the dangers attached to this form of journalism is enormous, even to the death of journalist, therefore big praises to those who continue to uphold the watchdog role of the media as stated in McQuail's Social Responsibility theory of the press.

5.3 Recommendations

1. Government: Should not by any means dictate what should be published in the media, this has effect on the freedom of the journalists and media professionals who want to perform their duties. There is absolute need for the freedom of the press. Regulations and deliberate misinterpretation of laws to suit a section of the society, organisation or government agency should be discouraged. Also National Broadcasting Commission and other regulating bodies should stop so called 'regulation', it is killing the media, which I perceive as imprisoning the media or press.
2. Media Owners: This study recommends that media owners should give ample freedom to journalist to exercise their professional duties and they should protect and never expose these professionals to dangers of those who claimed they have been injured by their reports. Also, they should provide financial motivation to journalists and media practitioners at the right time, this will reduce the level of 'brown envelope syndrome' that leads to ineffective reportage.
3. Journalists: Always consider the rules of engagement (code of conduct) of the profession, have a deep understanding of the law, know your right and collaborate with other journalists to fight this nemesis together. Also, journalist should never reveal their sources because this will discredit your reputation.